

Helen Webley-Brown

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Education

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| Ph.D. in Sociology , Stanford University | Palo Alto, CA |
| • Honors: CCSRE Emerging Scholar | Sept 2025 – Present |
| S.M. in Political Science , Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) | Cambridge, MA |
| • Thesis: Democracy Under Surveillance: The Effect of Pretrial Electronic Monitoring on Voting Behavior | Feb 2025 |
| • Fields: American Politics, Quantitative Methods [GPA: 4.9/5.0] | |
| A.B. in Political Science , Washington University in St. Louis (WashU) | St. Louis, MO |
| • Honors: Danforth Scholar, Civic Scholar, College Honors, Phi Beta Kappa [GPA: 3.97/4.0] | May 2022 |

Publications

- Webley-Brown, H.** and Sukin, L. (2026). [Divisions at Home, Broken Promises Abroad? How Domestic Politics Shapes the United States' Nuclear Credibility](#). International Studies Quarterly.
- Gupta, A., Wu, V., **Webley-Brown, H.**, King, J., and Ho, D. (2023). [The Privacy-Bias Tradeoff: Data Minimization and Racial Disparity Assessments in U.S. Government](#). ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT).
- [Best Paper Award](#) at FAccT, 2023
 - [Student Paper Award](#) from Future of Privacy Forum, 2023

Other Writing

- Webley-Brown, H.**, Sipek, A., Buoymaster, K., Shivalkar, J., Owen, W., and Manis, E. (2022). [ShotSpotter and the Misfires of Gunshot Detection Technology](#). Surveillance Technology Oversight Project.
- Loshkajian, N., Van Doran, S., Melendi, J., Saran, S., **Webley-Brown, H.**, and Manis, E. (2022). [Privatizing The Surveillance State: How Police Foundations Undermine Rule of Law](#). Surveillance Technology Oversight Project.

Working Papers

- Global Ideological Polarization In Nuclear Attitudes: Evidence From 23 Countries (with Lauren Sukin)
- Assessing the Impact of Generative AI Search Tools on Government-Citizen Information Exchange (with Chris Cai, Peter John, and Helen Margetts)
- Who Contacts Government and How? Survey Evidence from the UK (with Chris Cai, Peter John, and Helen Margetts)

Works in Progress

- Telling on Yourself To Build Trust: The Effect of Open Data Initiatives on Public Perceptions of the Police
- Why Watch The Watchers? Frame Utilization In Community Control Over Police Surveillance (CCOPS) Legislation
- Democracy at Home: How Racial Diversity in Public Housing Developments Shape Resident Council Emergence
- The Face of Public Housing: Measuring Descriptive Representation in Public Housing Authority Leadership

Research Experience

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| Research Assistant , Oxford Internet Institute (Prof. Helen Margetts) | London, England |
| • Analyzed original survey data on trends in UK citizen-government information exchange | Jan 2025 – Dec 2025 |
| Research Officer , LSE Phelan United States Center (Prof. Lauren Sukin) | London, England |
| • Conducted quantitative and archival data analysis across Dr. Sukin's research portfolio | Dec 2024 – Aug 2025 |
| Research Assistant , MIT Political Science (Prof. Ariel White) | Cambridge, MA |
| • Used Sequential Monte Carlo algorithm to analyze impact of prison gerrymandering | May 2023 – Aug 2023 |

reforms on legislative outcomes

Summer Research Fellow, Stanford Regulation, Evaluation, and Governance Lab

Remote

June 2022 – Aug 2022

- Conducted content analysis of 25 federal agencies' equity action plans
- Analyzed privacy-related barriers to data collection, and its impact on bias assessments

Research Intern, Surveillance Technology Oversight Project

Remote

Jan 2022 – May 2022

- Wrote two reports on emerging surveillance technologies' impact on civil rights
- Created data visualization of racial disparities in ShotSpotter technology deployment

Student Researcher, Modernist Prehistory of Facial Recognition Lab (Prof. Anca Parvulescu)

St. Louis, MO

Sept 2021 – Dec 2021

- Researched facial recognition's physiognomic roots using archival and literary analysis

Data Analysis and Research Intern, The Bail Project

St. Louis, MO

June 2021 – Aug 2021

- Performed data fidelity checks on Salesforce reports with 900+ unique client records
- Surveyed 43 clients and conducted 3 interviews to write [report](#) on socio-economic impacts of pretrial electronic monitoring

Research Assistant, WashU Sociology (Prof. Sarah Gaby)

St. Louis, MO

Jan 2020 – June 2020

- Analyzed sentiment in pre/post class survey data to track changes in protest attitudes

Teaching Assistant Experience

Making Public Policy (UG), MIT Political Science (Prof. Andrea Campbell)

Fall 2024

Quantitative Political Methodology (UG), WashU Political Science (Prof. Christopher Lucas)

Spring 2021

Social Movements (UG), WashU Sociology (Prof. Sarah Gaby)

Spring 2020

Pedagogical Training

MIT Teaching + Learning Lab Teaching Certificate

Fall 2024

- **Course Design Track** (backward design, inclusive class policies, syllabus development)
- **Lesson Planning Track** (giving formative feedback, active learning)
- **Inclusive Teaching Track** (strategies to foster a welcoming, equitable classroom)
- **Microteaching Track** (lecture skills, facilitating discussions, teaching demos)

Service

First-Year Representative, Association of Sociology Graduate Students, Stanford Sociology

Fall 2025 – Present

Co-Chair, Graduate Student Works-in-Progress Workshop, MIT Political Science

Fall 2023 – Spring 2024

Diversity Co-Chair, Graduate Student Council, MIT Political Science

Fall 2023 – Spring 2024

Mentor, Political Science Application Mentorship Program (PSAMP), MIT Political Science

Fall 2022

Conferences and Workshops

The Domestic Foundations of Nuclear Policy, Nuffield College (Oxford, UK)

2026

American Politics Group (APG) Early Career Researcher Conference, LSE (London, UK)

2025

BRIDGE Event on Electronic Monitoring, Arnold Ventures (Washington DC, USA)

2025

Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA), (Chicago, IL, USA)

2024

Grants and Awards

Stanford, CCSRE Emerging Scholars Award (3-year fellowship)

2025

MIT, Political Methodology Lab Research Grant (\$1000)

2023

Future of Privacy Forum, Student Paper Award (shared with co-authors)

2023

FACCT, Best Paper Award (shared with co-authors)

2023

WashU , Shepley Outstanding Senior Award	2022
WashU , Harriet K. Switzer Leadership Award	2022
WashU , Gephardt Institute Fox-Clark Civic Scholarship	2020
WashU , William H. Danforth Scholarship (4-year full tuition award)	2018

Non-Academic Experience

Legal Lark , Founder and Project Manager	St. Louis, MO
- Managed team of 4 to create website on e-carceration and juvenile justice - Built resource bank, designed infographics, and wrote articles on youth incarceration	May 2021 – May 2022
Government Affairs Intern , Human Rights Campaign	Remote
- Coded 506 cities' LGBTQ+ police liaison policies for HRC's Municipal Equality Index - Tracked politicians' votes and bill sponsorships for HRC's Congressional Scorecard	Jan 2021 – April 2021
Public Affairs and Communications Intern , Hanbury Strategy	London, England
Drafted client op-eds, government consultation responses, and stakeholder maps	June 2020 – Sept 2020
Campaign Donations Researcher , Lavender for State Senate	Remote
Researched past contributions of 300+ potential donors; out-raised incumbent by 106%	June 2020 – Aug 2020

Technical Skills

LaTeX, R and R Studio, Python, ArcGIS, QGIS